MariaDB: A Versatile Database Management System

Relational database management system (RDBMS) tools are essential for software developers. These are expected to be reliable, quick and secure. Among the large number of database systems out there, MariaDB stands out. Forked out from MySQL, MariaDB remains compatible with its parent system. It is used by the likes of Google, Mozilla, Wordpress and Wikipedia. Let's see what makes MariaDB so useful.

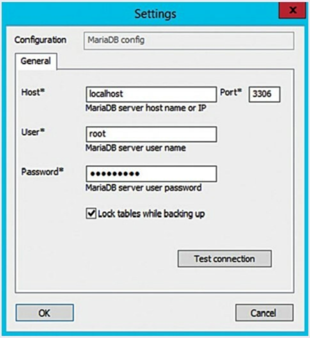

Fig. 1: MariaDB login

Working on MariaDB

MariaDB is an open source RDBMS that utilises MySQL code as the development platform. So it essentially acts as a drop-in replacement for MySQL, that is, you can replace the MySQL software with MariaDB without any necessary code or major setup changes.

The MySQL code has been cleaned up and shaped into a more stable and lighter database version. The best part of MariaDB is support for third-party software and its own storage engines—which we will discuss later in the article.

MariaDB is compatible with many platforms including Windows, MacOS and Linux distributions. Installation is easy and well instructed through setup files. You can use command line instructions for installation as root-user (if permission is available). Replacing existing MySQL setup with MariaDB is simple as well.

User authentication is required to start coding in MariaDB platform. The SQL environment is quite similar to most RDBMS, especially MySQL. The top bar has various menus like File, View, Favourites, Tools, Windows and Help. You can explore these to understand the different functions you can perform in the software.

Below the menu bar are a few essential quick buttons. For instance, Connection allows you to provide credentials for the database connection you want to work on. User lets you handle the user login. You can perform operations related to Tables, Views, Functions, Events or even Queries with the buttons that follow.

The left side of the screen contains a panel that categorises all the elements of the database. At the top it shows the connection server to which you pres-

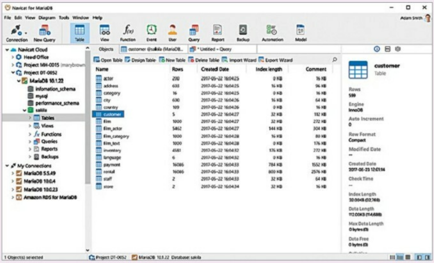

Fig. 2: A representation of MariaDB user interface